

Donte Dillard

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Systems Administrator with 6+ years of enterprise IT and infrastructure experience, currently managing Active Directory, Group Policy, and hybrid Azure AD environments for a 100+ user organization. Builds on a strong manufacturing systems and process-automation background — including SAP S/4HANA support and Python-based reconciliation tooling — to bring a data-driven, root-cause approach to infrastructure support. Hands-on with AWS EC2, Azure, PowerShell automation, and CI/CD pipelines through self-directed cloud labs. Targeting Systems Administrator and Cloud Engineer roles where enterprise IAM experience and cloud automation skills can be applied at scale.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Server Administration: Windows Server 2016/2019/2022, Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS), Domain Controllers, Group Policy (GPO), DNS, DHCP, NTFS Permissions, ACLs

Cloud Platforms: Microsoft Azure (Azure VMs, Azure AD, Azure AD Connect, Blob Storage), AWS EC2

Automation & Scripting: PowerShell, Terraform, Azure CLI, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), Python (Jupyter)

Identity & Access Management: Microsoft 365/Office 365, IAM Lifecycle, RBAC, Hybrid AD Environments

Operating Systems: Windows 10/11, Windows Server 2016–2022, macOS

Networking & Remote Tools: RDP, TeamViewer, TCP/IP, DNS/DHCP Troubleshooting, Nmap

IT Service Management: ServiceNow (ITSM), Incident/Problem/Request Management, SLA Compliance, ServiceNow Table API

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Windows Systems Administrator

Feb 2023 – Present

AbbVie — Branchburg, NJ

- Administer Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS) for a 100+ user environment, managing the full IAM lifecycle — provisioning, RBAC enforcement, and secure de-provisioning — reducing unauthorized access risk by eliminating 30+ dormant accounts identified during quarterly access reviews.
- Configure and maintain 15+ Group Policy Objects (GPOs) enforcing security baselines, password complexity, account lockout thresholds, and workstation compliance standards across all domain-joined endpoints.
- Execute endpoint provisioning and deployment for 50+ Windows workstations, including domain joins, security policy application, and imaging — reducing average setup time by 40% through standardized procedures.
- Resolve 200+ ServiceNow ITSM tickets per quarter, including Tier 2 escalations for Active Directory, Windows Server, and network infrastructure, maintaining SLA compliance across incident, problem, and request workflows.
- Perform advanced troubleshooting of AD replication failures, Kerberos/NTLM authentication issues, and account lockouts, reducing mean time to resolution (MTTR) through structured root-cause analysis documentation.
- Administer Microsoft 365/Office 365 for 100+ users, including mailbox provisioning, license management, and Azure AD identity synchronization across hybrid on-prem and cloud environments.
- Manage NTFS permissions, security groups, and ACLs across shared network resources, enforcing least-privilege access and data security compliance for 3+ file server environments.
- Support hybrid identity infrastructure integrating on-prem AD with Azure AD, assisting with VM provisioning, Azure AD Connect configuration, and directory synchronization across 2 environments.
- Monitor system performance across Windows Server and endpoint infrastructure, reducing unplanned downtime by proactively resolving recurring DNS and domain connectivity issues.
- Perform secure remote administration, diagnostics, and configuration management via RDP and TeamViewer across geographically distributed endpoints.
- Document 100% of infrastructure changes and incident resolutions in ServiceNow, improving audit readiness and new-hire onboarding speed.

Manufacturing Technician / Cell Lead / Software Specialist

Mar 2019 – Feb 2023

AbbVie Pharmaceutical — Branchburg, NJ

- Served as Lead SME for the migration from SAP ECC to S/4HANA, guiding implementation strategy and validating business process alignment; performed cross-functional troubleshooting, formal/informal testing, and CSV-based data analysis (cleaning, EDA, visualization) alongside senior data scientists.
- Led the EBR (SiBR) Transformation Program, coordinating cross-functional Manufacturing and BTS teams to digitize a paper-based process with real-time validations and equipment integration — driving a 30% reduction in manufacturing non-conformances post go-live.
- Developed a Python/Jupyter-based automated reconciliation tool comparing BTS network and SAP report data, validating record timestamps within a defined tolerance window to flag data currency issues and improve SPC data reliability.
- Served as sole SME across 5 concurrent process transformation projects, driving testing, validation, and documentation from active development through initial scoping.
- Directed the process validation lifecycle (testing, confirmation, sign-off) for new and transformed manufacturing processes, partnering with quality teams to finalize SOP updates.
- Led training and knowledge transfer for QC Lab personnel on new process workflows, supporting readiness for production transfer.
- Acted as primary point of contact for departmental troubleshooting, resolving process and system issues across teams.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS (SELF-DIRECTED CLOUD & AUTOMATION LABS)

Active Directory VM Lab — *AWS EC2, Windows Server 2025, Active Directory, RDP*

- Deployed and configured AD DS on a Windows Server EC2 instance from scratch; promoted the server to Domain Controller, configured VPC and security groups, and managed OUs/user accounts via ADUC — demonstrating end-to-end enterprise identity infrastructure build in a cloud environment.

Azure Static Website CI/CD Pipeline — *Azure Blob Storage, GitHub Actions, Azure CLI, HTML/CSS/JS*

- Built and deployed a static portfolio website to Azure Blob Storage with a fully automated CI/CD pipeline using GitHub Actions; configured service principal authentication and GitHub Secrets, implementing push-to-deploy automation that cut deployment time to under 2 minutes.

Active Directory PowerShell Automation Lab — *PowerShell, Active Directory, Windows Server*

- Developed a PowerShell script to automate AD user account creation, eliminating manual GUI-based provisioning; script configures user attributes, sets execution policies, and verifies creation via ADUC.

ServiceNow PowerShell Automation Lab — *PowerShell, ServiceNow Table API, REST, JSON*

- Automated ServiceNow incident creation using PowerShell and the Table REST API; implemented Base64 credential encoding, JSON payload construction, and API response verification.

ServiceNow Password Reset Simulation Lab — *ServiceNow, Active Directory, IT Help Desk Workflows*

- Simulated a full IT help desk password reset workflow integrating ServiceNow ticketing with AD account management, covering ticket creation, identity verification, password reset, user communication, and closure per enterprise IT security procedures.